Design Justification

MTM4681 Mobile Programming - Milestone 1 | Shared Subscription and Payment Tracker | Baran Tugay

Design Goals and Users

The app serves two groups: individual users who track their own subscriptions, and shared-subscription users (students, roommates, families) who split costs. Both groups open the app briefly, often to answer one question: "What is due soon?" or "Who has not paid?". Because the app deals with money, the design must feel calm and trustworthy, show the key numbers immediately, and never make the user guess the meaning of a status. Every choice below follows from these needs.

Color Palette

We use a Material 3 style palette built around a deep teal primary (#006A6A). Teal combines the calm and trust that blue gives to financial apps with the sense of "healthy money" that green suggests, and it avoids the aggressive, alarming feel of red-heavy finance apps. The background is a very light teal tint instead of pure white, which reduces glare and lets white cards stand out through contrast and elevation. Semantic colors are kept separate from the brand color: green means paid, amber means pending, red means error or destructive action, so a user never confuses a brand accent with a warning.

Role	Hex	Usage	Text on it	
Primary	#006A6A	Buttons, active tab, headings	White	
Primary Container	#CCE8E7	Selected items, highlighted cards	Black	
Background	#F4FBFA	Screen background	Black	
On Surface	#191C1C	Main text	(is the text color)	
Paid	#2E7D32	"Paid" status chip	White	
Pending	#9A5B00	"Pending" status chip	White	
Error	#BA1A1A	Delete action, form errors	White	

Every text and background pair is chosen so that the text is easy to read, even in bright sunlight: white text on the dark colors and black text on the light colors.

Typography

We chose Inter (Roboto as the Material 3 default fallback). Inter was designed for screens, stays readable at small sizes, and has tabular figures, so prices such as 99,99 and 47,50 line up in columns and are easy to compare. We use the Material 3 type scale with only four styles. A small, fixed set keeps the hierarchy clear: the monthly total is the largest element on the main screen, service names and prices come second, and dates and chips are the smallest. Weight (regular and medium only) is used for emphasis instead of many different fonts.

Style	Size	Used for
Headline Small	24 sp	Screen titles, monthly total
Title Medium	16 sp	Card titles, service names, prices
Body Medium	14 sp	Descriptions, form fields
Label Medium	12 sp	Dates, chips, captions

Layout and Navigation

- **Bottom navigation with four tabs** (Subscriptions, Groups, Statistics, Settings). The main destinations stay within thumb reach for one-handed use, which suits quick checks on a phone.

- **Summary first:** the main screen starts with this month's total (B_monthly), followed by filter chips (All / Personal / Shared) and the subscription list. The most important number is visible without scrolling.

- **Card-based lists** on an 8 px grid with 16 px side margins and 12 px corner radius. Each card shows logo, name, the user's share, and a renewal hint such as "Renews in 3 days", so the user can scan the list quickly.

- **One primary action per screen:** a floating action button (+) for adding a subscription, and a single filled button for saving or confirming. Destructive actions need a confirmation dialog. - Quick add: the service catalog pre-fills name, logo and average price, which reduces typing and entry mistakes.

Accessibility

- Status is never shown by color alone. The Paid and Pending chips combine color, an icon and a text label, so the status is clear for color-blind users and in bright sunlight.

- Touch targets of at least 48 x 48 px for buttons, chips, list rows and navigation items, which lowers the risk of accidental taps.

- Readable text: body text is 14 sp or larger, and layouts are designed to scale with the system font size setting. Form errors appear as red helper text with a message, not only as a red border.

- Clear labels and feedback: icons used for actions are paired with text where space allows, and every action gives feedback (snackbar after saving or deleting).

Motion

Animation is used only where it explains something, with 200-300 ms ease-out transitions. The subscription logo expands from the list card into the detail screen, so the user sees where they came from. Statistics bars and the payment status cards animate when the screen opens, which draws attention to the change in the data. New screens slide in from the direction of the action (right for deeper navigation, bottom for creating something new).

Consistency

All screens are built from a shared set of Figma components (subscription card, status chip, buttons, text field, app bar, bottom navigation) and shared color and text styles. This keeps the work of all team members visually consistent and maps directly to Flutter's Material 3 widgets and ThemeData, so the design can be implemented without redesign.